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Teaching Statement

I want students to leave an economics course able to explain a decision, evaluate an argument, and use evidence to reach a defensible conclusion. My approach moves from intuition to formal reasoning to empirical evidence, with practice at each step. My responsibility is to make challenging material accessible while holding students to clear standards. I seek a position where undergraduate teaching, student support, and sustained improvement of instruction are central responsibilities.

As an instructor for **Statistical Methods at Binghamton University in Summer 2025**, I had sole responsibility for the syllabus, learning objectives, lectures, problem sets, data exercises, assessments, and grading. As a teaching assistant for Introduction to Econometrics in Fall 2025 and Fall 2026, I teach econometric foundations and methods alongside leading the R programming component. My other teaching assistantships span introductory and intermediate microeconomics, macroeconomics, corporate economics, and advanced data analytics. These roles have given me experience supporting students across the economics curriculum and connecting conceptual understanding with quantitative practice.

Making Economic Reasoning Visible

In introductory microeconomics, I begin with choices students recognize: how a household responds to a price change, why a firm enters a market, or how a tax affects exchange. I ask students to predict an effect before drawing a diagram or writing an equation. The model then helps them identify what is held fixed and why the prediction follows. For a tax problem, the important learning goal is to connect the change in prices and quantities to who bears the burden and why elasticity matters. Short checks for understanding ask students to translate a verbal scenario into a graph and explain the graph in words. This gives me a way to distinguish a memorized diagram from an economic argument.

Supporting Intermediate Microeconomics highlighted the importance of connecting diagrams to constrained optimization. I organize explanations around three questions: What is the decision maker trying to achieve? What limits the choice? Which assumption drives the result? In macroeconomics, I connect accounting and models to questions about inflation, unemployment, and growth, using data to assess the explanation. Across these settings, I want students to articulate a mechanism and recognize a model's limits before applying it to a new problem.

Building Foundations for Econometric Reasoning

In my econometrics TA classes, I teach the foundations of regression, the classical assumptions, the Gauss–Markov theorem, hypothesis testing, the consequences of assumption failures, causal inference, and panel data methods. Before introducing a difficult concept, I build the foundation students need to understand it. I begin with a relatable economic question, explain the relevant intuition and prerequisite ideas, and then develop the formal argument. This sequence allows me to explain the material rigorously while giving students a clear reason for each new concept.

When explaining the classical assumptions and the Gauss–Markov theorem, I connect each condition to the properties of least squares that it supports. I distinguish unbiasedness, efficiency, and valid inference, and explain why different assumption failures require different responses. This foundation supports hypothesis testing and prepares students to understand identification in causal inference and the role of unobserved heterogeneity in panel data. My goal is for students to explain why a method is appropriate and what would undermine its conclusions.

In R, students connect these ideas to importing and cleaning data, estimating and diagnosing models, interpreting uncertainty, and producing reproducible scripts. Simulation makes the logic concrete: generating data with a known parameter and then omitting a relevant variable lets students compare an estimate with the truth. My professional experience in data science and engineering also supplies examples of why data definitions, documentation, and clear communication matter beyond the classroom.

Supporting Participation and Assessing Understanding

Students enter economics courses with different levels of confidence in mathematics, programming, and discussion. My course-design priorities are explicit expectations, a clear sequence of tasks, and several ways to participate. In future courses, I plan to use an ungraded diagnostic and targeted review exercises to address prerequisite gaps. Annotated starter scripts would support initial programming assignments, with guidance gradually withdrawn. Brief individual writing before paired discussion would give students time to formulate an answer before speaking.

Assessment should reveal reasoning and help students act on feedback. I plan to pair low-stakes practice with individual assessments of explanation, application, and interpretation. A rubric would distinguish economic reasoning, technical execution, and communication. When reviewing errors, I would ask students to explain a correction and apply the idea to a new problem. Office hours would help students diagnose difficulties and identify a manageable next step.

I also plan to use short end-of-class questions and anonymous midsemester feedback to guide improvements. Comparing performance on related questions across assignments would help me assess whether a revised explanation addressed the difficulty. I would communicate changes to students and seek peer observation and pedagogical training to improve my practice.

Developing Resources for Independent Learning

I am currently building a learning platform to make production-function analysis, empirical industrial organization (EIO), and efficiency analysis more accessible through clear explanations and simulations. The platform extends my emphasis on building foundations before introducing advanced methods. My aim is to help students connect economic intuition, formal models, and computational results, with opportunities to revisit difficult ideas at their own pace. This work brings my research expertise into teaching and reflects my commitment to developing resources that support learning beyond scheduled class time.

Contributing to a Teaching-Focused Department

I am prepared to contribute to the core curriculum in principles and intermediate microeconomics, principles of macroeconomics, statistics, and introductory econometrics. I can also offer courses in data analytics, applied econometrics, panel data, and causal inference. For an advanced empirical course, I would develop a staged project in which students formulate a question, document a public dataset, justify their method, and present a reproducible analysis. Intermediate submissions would create opportunities for feedback before the final paper and presentation. My research can supply manageable examples for these courses, including simulations that show why different methods produce different answers.

I would welcome opportunities to advise undergraduate empirical projects and support students exploring research, graduate study, or careers using economic data. My aim is to be a dependable contributor to required courses and a thoughtful mentor as students develop independent work. The standard I want my teaching to meet is whether students can take an unfamiliar economic question, reason through it carefully, and communicate what they have learned with confidence and appropriate caution.